

Chapter 7: Assessments

Assessment stands as a fundamental and integral component of the educational process, holding significance for both students and faculty, as well as the institution. For students, its importance lies in the fact that it affects the decisions of passing and failing in an education block, ranking, awards and distinctions, and the issue of transcripts. For the institution, assessments offer crucial grounds for program evaluation, supplying valuable insights for curriculum development and evolution.

1. Programmatic Assessment

Programmatic assessment is a comprehensive approach to evaluating student learning and performance within an educational program. Unlike traditional assessment methods that focus on individual exams or assignments, programmatic assessment considers a broader range of evidence gathered over an extended period at different data points. It seeks to provide a holistic view of a student's progress and competence throughout the entire educational experience.

This approach involves various types of assessments, including formative assessments, which occur during the learning process to guide instruction, and summative assessments, which evaluate overall achievement at the conclusion of a program or a significant phase. The goal is to foster ongoing improvement in both teaching methods and student outcomes.

2. Types of Assessments

Two types of assessments will be conducted during the implementation of OSIS: Summative and Formative.

a. Formative Assessment (Assessment for Learning)

The primary objectives of formative assessments are to encourage student learning, gauge their progress, and enable faculty to evaluate the effectiveness of their teaching methods.

- (1) Regular formative assessments will be conducted during or after lectures, practical, as part of SGDs, CBLs and or demo/dissection.
- (2) The strategies for formative assessment will include critical reasoning, MCQs, SAQs/ SEQs, Assignments and or Presentations.
- (3) These assessments will not carry weightage in the final examination and will be used to provide comprehensive feedback to the students.

b. Summative Assessments (Assessment of Learning)

Summative assessments will be taken at three levels:

- (1) Low Stake Assessments (LSA) □ during the modules.
- (2) Mid Stake Assessments (MSA) □ as End of Block (EOB) exam at the end of each block.
- (3) Professional Exams □ 4 weeks after the last EOB exam

3. Weightage of Summative Assessments

- a. **Low Stake Assessments (LSA)** will carry 10% weightage.
- b. **Mid Stake Assessments (MSA)** i.e. **End of Block exam** will carry 20% weightage.
- c. **High-Stake Assessment (HSA)** i.e. **Professional Exam** will carry 70% weightage.
- d. The LSAs and MSAs together constitute the **Internal Assessment**.
- e. The final score of the individual student is calculated by summing up the weightages of internal assessment (LSA + EOB) i.e. 30% and Professional exam (70%) for that year.

4. Low Stake Assessments (LSA):

Low stake assessments are part of the programmatic assessments providing multiple data points. There will be 2-4 assessments per module.

- These assessments include the scores of PBLs and module exams.
- LSA will constitute of 25 MCQs of 30 mins duration. Total marks will be 25.
- The theory paper of LSAs will be discipline based, however 1 integrated OSPE/ OSCE per block will be conducted as part of LSA.

5. Mid Stake Assessments (MSA):

Mid-stake assessments include end of block (EOB) exams.

- There will be 3 EOBs in a year that will be conducted at the end of each block. The content of EOB will be from the modules taught in that specified block.
- The EOBs will consist of a theory paper and practical (OSPE/ OSCE including viva) exam.
- EOB will constitute of 150 MCQs of 3 hours duration. The marks of theory paper will be 150.
- Practical sessions (OSPE/ OSCE) consist of 15 stations each. Each OSPE/OSCE station has a duration of 5 mins and carry 05 marks.
- These exams will be conducted by NSHS and will be on the same pattern as the professional exams.
- There will be no re-sit assessment for the end of block (EOBs) assessments.

6. Professional Examinations:

The professional examinations are the high-stake examinations conducted at the end of each year. These exams will be conducted by the University i.e. NUST Examination directorate.

- a. There will be 3 papers in each professional examination, where each paper will correspond to the EOBs of that specific year. i.e.
Paper I □ EOB I
Paper II □ EOB II
Paper III □ EOB III
- b. Each paper will consist of theory, practical (OSPE/OSCE) and Viva examinations.
- c. Theory paper will consist of 150 MCQs of 3 hours duration.
- d. Practical sessions (OSPE/ OSCE) consist of 15 stations each. Each OSPE/OSCE station has a duration of 5 mins and carry 05 marks.
- e. A student, in order to be declared successful in the professional examination, will have to obtain minimum **50% marks**, in both theory and practical part of the examination **SEPARATELY**, in the final scoring.
- f. In accordance with the PM&DC rule any student who fails to clear the first and 2nd Professional MBBS examinations in four attempts either availed or un-availed, shall cease to become eligible for further medical education at NSHS.

7. Eligibility Criteria For Appearing In Professional Examination:

- a. Min of 75% attendance is mandatory to appear in the professional exam.
- b. Students having less than 75% attendance in both theory & practical separately will not be allowed to appear in professional examination.

8. Nomenclature of professional examinations

Year	Examinations
1 st Year MBBS	1 st Professional Examination
2 nd Year MBBS	2 nd Professional Examination
3 rd Year MBBS	3 rd Professional Examination
4 th Year MBBS	4 th Professional Examination
5 th Year MBBS	Final Professional Examination

9. Tools for Summative Assessment:

A diverse set of assessment tools will be used, including:

- a. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)
- b. Objective Structured Practical Examinations (OSPEs)
- c. Objective Structured Clinical Examinations (OSCEs)
- d. Structured Viva examinations
- e. PBL Scores

10. Supplementary Examination

- a. A supplementary examination will be held 2-4 weeks after the declaration of the result of the professional examination.
- b. Students failing to pass the annual examination will be allowed to appear in the supplementary examination provided they fulfil the attendance criteria for appearing in the examination.
- c. Those who fail to pass supplementary examination, will be detained in the same class.
- d. Any student failing in ONE paper will take a supplementary exam of the same paper. Similarly, if the student fails to pass the same paper in the supplementary exam, then he/she will be detained and will appear in the same paper next year. The remaining passed papers will be considered pass.
- e. For the candidates appearing in the supplementary examinations, the weightage of EOBs will be maintained.
- f. Final scoring for the candidates appearing in the supplementary examination will be the sum of 30% weightage of their scores in internal assessment (LSA + EOB) and 70% weightage of supplementary examination.

11. Appeals

The candidate will have the right to appeal for any grievance related to assessment through specified proformas available at NSHS. The competent authority of NSHS/ NUST will consider all appeals on merit and will decide accordingly. The decision of the NUST in all such cases will be final.

12. Procedure for appeal:

- a. Contact the Student Affairs office to obtain the official appeal form.
- b. Carefully fill out the appeal form, providing all required information. Clearly state the grounds for the appeal and provide any supporting documentation or evidence.
- c. The appeal will be reviewed by a grievance committee designated by the Principal. This committee will assess the grounds of the appeal and review any supporting evidence provided.
- d. Once the grievance committee has reached a decision, the student will be notified of the outcome in writing. This communication should include the reasons for the decision and any further steps if required.
- e. Throughout the appeals process, it's crucial for students to maintain professionalism and adhere to the institution's code of conduct. Respectful communication and adherence to established procedures can contribute to a fair and efficient resolution.